Insights / Needs Chart: APSS Research Website

Each row is a theme from our affinity diagram (Content, Navigation, Visuals), with evidence from our four empathy maps of Erin Hidlebaugh, APSS Program Coordinator. A condensed version was presented on slide 5 at the October 7 customer check-in.

Sources: affinity diagram, empathy maps 1 to 4, check-in slides

Theme	Example from our research	What visitors need	Why it matters
Content: show the research	Erin wants projects, a timeline, journal entries and community reports online. "Publish research" is a gain in two empathy maps.	Browse current and completed projects, open articles and posters, follow updates	APSS research exists but has no home online, so partners, funders and researchers cannot find or cite it
Content: plain language	All four empathy maps list the same pain: the current site is "too scientific", "too much text", "boring".	Short overviews written for the public, with detail one click deeper	Erin describes the audience as "average people, no scientists". Dense text drives them away
Content: impact	Affinity notes: "keep the impact statistics/numbers", "keep the impact numbers visually noticeable".	See what the research changed, in a few clear figures	Numbers make the work credible to funders and keep casual visitors reading
Navigation: quick paths	Affinity notes: "one-click access to support", "report a needle easily". Erin "wishes for people to access information quickly".	Reach any project, publication or partner site in one or two clicks	Erin calls the old site "too confusing". A short menu and clear links are the fix
Navigation: connected sites	Empathy map 3: "a link to redirect to the new site would be good". The project brief places the site beside the main APSS site and reportneedles.ca.	Move between the research site, the main APSS site and reportneedles.ca without getting lost	Three sites serve one mission. Visitors should never feel they have left APSS
Visuals: authentic and colourful	Empathy maps 1, 2 and 4: "no AI pictures", "really wants colours, good visuals", likes the Eaton Lab website. Affinity notes: "use real APSS photos", "use consistent image style".	Real photos of staff, events and the building, in a colourful, consistent style	Erin rejects AI images outright. Consent and authenticity are project constraints, and Eaton Lab is the benchmark she named